



WHEN HAITIANS NEED TO GET ACROSS THEIR SUNNY island or make their way around the capital city, Port au Prince, they hop aboard one of the rickety local buses called tap-taps, which are covered with brightly painted folk motifs. Passengers who want to get off tap several times on the vehicle's wooden side to let the driver know, and this is how the buses got their name. Travel by tap-tap is crowded and noisy (music often blares from loud speakers), but it's also friendly and courteous: in crowded conditions, women and children sit inside, while men cling to the sides and the top, where the baggage is stored.

